

Rahaf Abutarbush

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🌐 <https://www.rahfabutarbush.com/> 🗣️ Arabic (Native) English (Fluent)

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University, BSC. in Information Systems Sep 2018 – May 2022

- Minor: Business Administration, concentration in Human-computer Interaction & User Experience
- Honors: Senior Leadership Award, Dean's list 2021

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

PwC Middle East, Frontier Labs Lead - Qatar May 2022 – present

- Identified and supported \$73M+ in AI opportunities with government clients across the GCC, translating client challenges into product roadmaps and funded projects.
- Shaped the AI use case portfolio for a multi-million-dollar government innovation lab opportunity in Qatar and Saudi Arabia
- Led AI design workshops and ideation sessions with CEOs, governors, and ministers, aligning technical possibilities with client priorities.
- Founded the AI pod within PwC's Emerging Technology Lab and led the development of government-focused AI use cases.
- Restructured the Emerging Technology Lab from a cost center into a revenue-generating model by developing monetizable AI use cases.
- Set the lab's annual strategy and roadmap around client needs and market demand.
- Delivered 90+ AI and emerging technology workshops and presentations to 1,000+ government stakeholders with varied technical backgrounds.
- Promoted twice in three years, from Associate to Manager, while founding and scaling Qatar's Emerging Technology Lab.

QCapsule Industries, Co-founder Apr 2025 – Present

- Conceptualized and designed QCapsule, a modular smart living infrastructure targeting hospitality, government, and remote environments across the GCC
- Led product strategy end-to-end, from concept and physical prototype through market positioning and GTM exploration
- Produced all marketing assets using AI, generating product visuals, videos, and architectural floor plans via Higgsfield, and developing marketing copy and GTM strategy using Claude
- Defined use cases for tourism, government, and off-grid operations, including secure and rapidly deployable units

RK Techhub, Founder Dec 2021 – present

- Built a custom multi-agent AI development pipeline from scratch, orchestrating specialist agents (architect, designer, developer, QA) to automate the full web application build lifecycle
- Architected and deployed web applications using React, Vite, Supabase, and Vercel using Claude Code, Cursor, and Lovable
- Built client dashboards and progress tracking systems; designed reusable UI systems translating product concepts into digital experiences

KEY PROJECTS

- AI Concierge System (Hospitality Pilot): Designed and product-managed a conversational AI concierge with 7Rooms integration, Arabic voice interface, and operator dashboard; scoped use cases, defined performance requirements, and oversaw build
- CityOS (Smart City Platform): Product-managed a cross-sector data aggregation platform for GCC smart city infrastructure, addressing fragmentation across transport, infrastructure, and government services
- National Innovation Lab (Confidential): Contributed to winning and delivering a national initiative, building prototypes aligned with Qatar National Development Strategy
- Daclimb (Productivity Platform): Built an end-to-end productivity dashboard for neurodivergent users using vibe coding tools, focusing on structured UX and real-world usability

Thought leadership reports

- A playbook for building national innovation programmes (Turning labs into innovation engines) - 2026
- Emerging Technologies in the Middle East - 2025
- Emerging tech in Qatar Banking report -2024
- Metaverse Assembly outcomes Report with Dubai Future Foundation - 2022

SKILLS & ENGAGEMENTS

Technical Skills

- AI Product Tools: Lovable, Claude Code, Cursor, Figma, Miro, Canva, Higgsfield
- AI Development: Custom multi-agent pipeline development, prompt engineering, LLM application development, AI use case scoping and evaluation
- Programming: Python (OpenCV, app development), React, Vite, Supabase, SQL
- Languages: Arabic (Native), English (Fluent)

Ecosystem Engagement

- Advised CMU's iX emerging technology lab
- Career coach to 4 team members, guiding their development and helping them fast-track growth and performance.
- Designed and led emerging technology workshops for students aged 9–16, fostering early interest in innovation and tech.
- Business Innovation Mentor at Lifelines Hackathon
- Judge at Carnegie Mellon's Tech Startup Launchpad 2022-2026
- Judge at Alice Programming competitions
- Panels and talks on life from university to industry

Representation at Global & Regional Events

- Delivered keynote at Web Summit Qatar 2026 on "What changes when AI can see, hear, and act"
- Spoke at Georgetown University and Carnegie Mellon University in Qatar on AI, emerging technologies, and applied innovation
- Featured panelist across global AI and tech forums, including Microsoft Women in Tech initiatives and major conferences (Web Summit Qatar, LEAP 2023–2024, World AI Summit 2024, Metaverse & AI Assembly 2022–2023), engaging senior stakeholders across government, enterprise, and academia
- Recognized in international media, including Euronews and WIRED, for contributions to emerging technology and innovation
- Mentored early-stage builders at hackathons (e.g., Lifelines), supporting development of AI-enabled and crisis-response solutions
- Contributed to ecosystem-level initiatives tied to national technology infrastructure, including the Microsoft Data Center Launch in Qatar
- Actively engaged across Middle East and European innovation ecosystems through participation in international forums (e.g., DEALS 2023, Spain) and cross-market collaboration

Extracurriculars & Leadership Roles

- Captain of Carnegie Mellon Arabic Debate Team
- President & Executive Producer of TEDxCMUQ
- Outreach director of the Information Systems Association
- President of the Carnegie Consulting Club